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MEDIA CONTACT

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PASADENA COMMUNITY TO HONOR MENTOR PERVIS POLK WITH INAUGURAL 3x3 TOURNAMENT

Fifty teams will compete August 15–16, 2026 at Blair High School; proceeds fund \$1,000 donations to three local high schools — including a scholarship in Polk’s name at his alma mater, John Muir High School.

PASADENA, Calif. — The inaugural Pervis Polk Memorial 3x3 Tournament — the “Pervis Polk Cup” — will bring 50 teams to Blair High School for a two-day, Olympic-style 3x3 basketball tournament on Saturday and Sunday, August 15–16, 2026, honoring the late Pervis Polk, a father, brother, friend, and longtime mentor to generations of Pasadena athletes.

Built on the values Polk lived by — family, community, and competition — the tournament will donate \$1,000 each to three local high schools: Blair High School, Pasadena Poly High School, and John Muir High School. John Muir, Polk’s alma mater, will receive its \$1,000 to seed a scholarship fund established in his name.

The tournament follows the international FIBA 3x3 format used in the Olympic Games — fast, entertaining, half-court games. Fifty five-person teams (three players plus two substitutes) will be divided into 10 pools of five for a full round-robin on Saturday, with every team guaranteed four games. Sunday features three single-elimination brackets — a Championship, a Consolation, and a Community bracket — so all 50 teams keep playing into the second day, culminating in the crowning of the first Pervis Polk Cup champion.

“To provide opportunities to help our community and be a positive influence on the cities of Pasadena and Altadena, where Pervis’ roots are,” said Ron Wilson, Tournament Commissioner.

A SIGNATURE FROM THE FOUNDERS: “CAL TECH 17”

Every Pervis Polk Cup game is played to 17 points — a nod to a pickup game Polk and Wilson once played at Caltech, directly across the street from the Pasadena Poly courts where they hooped for years. That day’s games happened to end at 17 — an unusual number in pickup culture, where games typically go to 7, 9, 11, or 21. The two never forgot it and called it “Cal Tech 17.” The championship game is the lone exception, played to the traditional 21.

With a \$250 entry fee per team, the tournament expects to raise \$12,500 — funding the \$3,000 in school donations along with tournament operations, team jerseys, cash prizes for the Champion and Runner-Up, and a set-aside to sustain and grow the event in future years. All four podium teams — Champion, Runner-Up, third place, and Consolation Champion — will also receive commemorative hats and free entry to the next Pervis Polk Cup.

The event is open to male and female players ages 16 and older; players 16 or 17 must have a parent or guardian sign the liability waiver and receive committee approval. Organizers are seeking teams, sponsors, and community partners. Sponsorship opportunities range from in-kind donations to a title sponsorship, with brand placement on banners, courts, jerseys, and event materials.

Team registration and sponsorship information are available at [TOURNAMENT WEBSITE — TBD] or by contacting the committee at [COMMITTEE EMAIL — TBD].

Event at a Glance

- What: 1st Annual Pervis Polk Memorial 3x3 Tournament (the “Pervis Polk Cup”)
- When: Saturday & Sunday, August 15–16, 2026
- Where: Blair High School, Pasadena, California
- Field: 50 teams · ages 16+ (16–17 need parent/guardian waiver + approval) · five players per team
- Format: Olympic-style FIBA 3x3 — games to 17 (“Cal Tech 17”), championship to 21; Day 1 pool play, Day 2 championship, consolation & community brackets
- Entry: \$250 per team
- Impact: \$1,000 each to Blair High, Pasadena Poly, and John Muir (John Muir donation seeds a scholarship in Pervis Polk’s name)

About the Pervis Polk Cup

The Pervis Polk Memorial 3x3 Tournament is a community event honoring the legacy of Pervis Polk, who mentored generations of Pasadena athletes. Founded on the principles of family, community, and competition, the tournament raises funds for local high schools and celebrates the game Polk loved. The Pervis Polk Cup is organized independently by its founding commissioners and is not affiliated with any other organization.

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Note to editors: Interviews with organizers, additional background on Pervis Polk, and event photography are available upon request. Please direct all media inquiries to [COMMITTEE EMAIL — TBD].